

board. Motherboards often require firmware updates to support newer features and hardware. Finally, load Windows XP Home on your PC if gaming is your main need. It shores up to the needs of most games and is easy on the pocket too.

Q I would like to know more about HyperThreading. I have heard a lot about this new product from Intel. I have an assembled PC that comprises an Intel D845GEBV2 motherboard (which has an external AGP slot and Extreme Graphics onboard as well), an Intel 1.7 GHz, 512 MB RAM and a 80 GB Seagate Barracuda hard disk. I would like to exchange my current motherboard for Intel's new HyperThreaded one. Do you recommend the exchange, or should I make do with my present configuration? I intend switching to a HyperThreaded motherboard since it's relatively faster, and supports multitasking. Can you recommend motherboards that are better than the one I have in mind? If so, please suggest some that have an external AGP slot, as I have a graphics card. Also, please let me know the cost involved.

Siddharth

A Intel's HyperThreading technology pertains to processors and not to motherboards. Intel's latest CPUs have this feature, and nearly all new motherboards for the Pentium 4 platform support it. For performance, there will be a marginal gain, and that, only with applications optimised for HyperThreading.

Unfortunately, as of today, there are few such applications. Nevertheless, some applications actually see a performance drop when used with HyperThreaded processors. However, you have a pretty decent machine and there is absolutely no reason to shift to a newer configuration as of now.

Q I have a Pentium 4 1.4 GHz machine, running both Windows 98 and Windows XP Professional. The display card is SiS630 on a Vintron motherboard. When I play *Back Alley Brawl*, I get an error that says I don't have the latest version of OpenGL. Where shall I get this?

Jayharsh Krishnakumar